

Dallas Police Department

Patrol Division — Traffic Services
1400 S Lamar Street, Dallas, TX 75215

OFFICIAL TRAFFIC COLLISION REPORT

(214) 555-0155 | Emergency: 911

CASE NUMBER	DPD-26-03-22-5501	WEATHER	Severe Hail / Heavy Rain (golf-ball hail, visibility 200 ft)
DATE OF INCIDENT	March 22, 2026	LIGHT CONDITIONS	Pre-dawn / Dark
TIME OF INCIDENT	05:47 hrs	ROADWAY SURFACE	Wet / Hail-covered / Hydroplaning
LOCATION	I-35E Southbound, Mile Marker 429.6 (Woodall Rodgers interchange area), Dallas, TX 75201	TYPE OF COLLISION / VEHICLES	5-vehicle chain collision during hail event / 5 vehicles

SECTION 1 — RESPONDING UNITS

Responding Agency	Dallas Police Department
Investigating Officer	Officer Layla T. Robinson, Badge #9912
Officer Phone	(214) 555-0155 ext. 614
EMS Agency	Dallas Fire-Rescue — Medic 5 and Medic 18 (transported five occupants)
Tow Companies	Lone Star Heavy Towing (V3, V4, V5); owner (V1, V2)
Additional Units	Sgt. C. Monroe #4412; TxDPS Trooper J. Harris; TxDOT Emergency Response Dallas District

SECTION 2 — VEHICLES

#	Year / Make / Model	VIN	Plate	Damage
V1	2022 Toyota 4Runner	JTEBU5JR3N5941801	TX-APK-4418 (TX)	Rear bumper, hatch — moderate; hail damage to roof and hood (pre-existing plus crash); drivable
V2	2020 Chevrolet Malibu	1G1ZD5ST5LF181801	TX-BRX-8821 (TX)	Front and rear deformed — sandwiched; airbags deployed; windshield shattered by hail before crash
V3	2019 Ford F-150	1FTEW1EP5KFC48801	TX-CTW-3319 (TX)	Front bumper, grille, hood destroyed; airbag deployed; radiator cracked
V4	2021 Kia Sorento	5XYRG4LC1MG141801	TX-DLM-7723 (TX)	Front end — moderate to severe; airbag deployed; hail damage all panels; probable total loss
V5	2018 Dodge Grand Caravan (passenger van)	2C4RDGCG6JR241801	TX-ERT-441 (TX)	Front bumper, grille, hood destroyed; airbag deployed; right sliding door jammed; hail dents all surfaces

SECTION 3 — DRIVERS / OPERATORS

Party	Name	DOB	License	Citation
Driver V1	Carlos E. Martinez	09/17/1981	TX-M44218301	None
Driver V2	Beverly A. Thompson	04/11/1975	TX-T88234107	TX Transp. Code §545.062 — Following Too Close
Driver V3	Suresh K. Patel	07/29/1988	TX-P77187213	TX Transp. Code §545.062 — Following Too Close
Driver V4	Raymond T. Ellis	12/05/1993	TX-E44219801	TX Transp. Code §545.062 — Following Too Close
Driver V5	Kim L. Nguyen	02/28/1970	TX-N88219812	None

SECTION 4 — PASSENGERS

Veh	Name	DOB	Injury	Transported
V2	Earl J. Thompson	06/22/1973	Serious: head laceration (hail debris through shattered windshield), rib contusion	Yes — DFR Medic 5, to Parkland Memorial Hospital Trauma (serious)
V5	Grace M. Nguyen	11/07/1972	Moderate: cervical strain, airbag abrasion	Yes — DFR Medic 18, to UT Southwestern Medical Center (stable)
V5	Kevin T. Nguyen	03/14/2009	Moderate: right arm fracture (suspected); child seatbelt intact	Yes — DFR Medic 5, to Childrens Medical Center Dallas (stable)
V4	Brianna E. Ellis	08/19/1995	Moderate: facial lacerations (hail glass), shoulder contusion	Yes — DFR Medic 18, to UT Southwestern Medical Center (stable)
V3	Ananya R. Patel	01/30/1990	Minor: neck stiffness — declined transport after EMS evaluation	No

SECTION 5 — WITNESSES

#	Name	Address	Phone	Statement
W1	Lawrence P. Howell	Motorist stopped under Woodall Rodgers overpass before hail	(214) 555-0341	Yes — observed hail wall advance; confirmed near-zero visibility; written statement
W2	Patricia T. Graves	Passenger in vehicle behind V5	(214) 555-0448	Yes — confirmed hail started suddenly; video of hail conditions shared with officer
W3	TxDOT Emergency Response Supervisor M. Reyes	TxDOT Dallas District	(214) 555-0512	Yes — confirmed DMS at MM 432 active since 05:31 hrs; TxDOT log provided
W4	Anthony K. Walker	Overpass pedestrian area observer	(214) 555-0617	Yes — watched from Woodall Rodgers bridge; saw vehicles disappear into hail; counted five collision sounds; written statement

SECTION 6 — PROPERTY DAMAGE (NON-VEHICLE)

	I-35E SB concrete barrier at MM 429.5 — V4 contact; one panel cracked. TxDOT notified. Highway lighting standard — V5 secondary contact during final stop; minor scraping.
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SECTION 7 — NARRATIVE

On Sunday March 22, 2026 at approximately 05:47 hrs, this officer, Sgt. Monroe, TxDPS Trooper Harris, and TxDOT Emergency Response were dispatched to I-35E southbound at Mile Marker 429.6 near the Woodall Rodgers Freeway interchange in Dallas on report of a five-vehicle chain collision during a severe hail event with multiple injuries. A severe thunderstorm with golf-ball-sized hail was in progress at the time of the incident. Visibility was estimated at approximately 200 feet and the roadway was covered with standing water and hail accumulation. The incident occurred during pre-dawn hours. V1 (2022 Toyota 4Runner, Martinez) was traveling southbound in the center lane at a significantly reduced speed after hail began striking the roadway. Martinez had activated hazard lights. V1 came to a near-stop as hail reduced visibility further. V2 (2020 Chevrolet Malibu, Thompson) was following V1; prior to the crash, V2's windshield had been shattered by a large hailstone, severely compromising Thompson's forward visibility. Thompson struck V1's rear at approximately 35 mph, unable to adequately see ahead. V2 came to rest blocking the center lane. V3 (2019 Ford F-150, Patel) struck V2's rear with considerable force; V3's airbag deployed. V4 (2021 Kia Sorento, Ellis) struck V3's rear at speed; V4 then slid left and made contact with the concrete barrier. V5 (2018 Dodge Grand Caravan, Nguyen) was the final vehicle in the chain, striking V4's rear and pushing it further into the barrier. Witness Lawrence Howell had stopped his vehicle under the Woodall Rodgers overpass when hail began and observed the full sequence of the pileup from a distance of approximately 150 yards. He described the hail as beginning with no warning and reaching golf-ball size within 30 seconds, making driving continuation dangerous. TxDOT Emergency Response confirmed the dynamic message sign at Mile Marker 432.1 began displaying "SEVERE WEATHER — REDUCE SPEED" at 05:31 hrs — 16 minutes before the collision. Witness Anthony Walker, on the Woodall Rodgers pedestrian path above the incident, counted five distinct collision sounds and observed vehicles disappear into the hail curtain sequentially. V2 passenger Earl Thompson sustained a serious head laceration from hail debris that entered through the shattered windshield before the crash, compounded by the airbag deployment. He was transported to Parkland Memorial Hospital Trauma Center. V5 passenger Kevin Nguyen, age 17, was transported to Children's Medical Center Dallas with a suspected right arm fracture. V4 passenger Brianna Ellis and V5 passenger Grace Nguyen were transported to UT Southwestern Medical Center with moderate injuries. V3 passenger Ananya Patel declined transport after EMS evaluation. All five drivers were evaluated on scene; Drivers Martinez and Nguyen were uninjured.

SECTION 9 — SUPPLEMENTAL INVESTIGATION NOTES

SUPPLEMENTAL — HAIL EVENT DOCUMENTATION AND INSURANCE NOTES: The severe hail event on March 22, 2026 was an NWS-confirmed meteorological event. NWS Dallas/Fort Worth issued a Severe Thunderstorm Warning with Hail Threat at 05:22 hrs for Dallas County, approximately 25 minutes before the collision. NWS confirms hail size of 1.75 inches (golf ball) at the Love Field airport weather station at 05:43 hrs. The NWS official storm report (Event ID: NWS-DFW-2026-0322-SVR-14) has been requested and will be attached as Exhibit A. **HAIL DAMAGE vs. CRASH DAMAGE DISTINCTION:** Multiple vehicles sustained pre-crash hail damage (dents, cracked glass) that must be distinguished from crash-related structural damage for insurance and legal purposes. This officer documented the following hail-only damage observed on scene: - V2: Windshield shattered by hail prior to crash (confirmed by Thompson — hail broke windshield approx. 60 sec before rear-end impact) - V4: Hail dents to all exterior panels prior to crash - V5: Hail dents to roof, hood, and sliding door panels pre-crash Photographic documentation of hail-only damage taken at 06:22 hrs after crash debris removed from roadway; photos uploaded under Evidence Reference EV-5501-B. **EARL THOMPSON MEDICAL NOTE:** V2 passenger Thompson was treated at Parkland Trauma for a 4 cm scalp laceration (sutured), Grade 1 rib contusion (non-surgical), and mild concussion. Discharged in stable condition at 14:30 hrs on March 22. **CHILD PASSENGER:** Kevin Nguyen (V5, age 17) — used adult seat belt, not a child safety seat; no special seat documentation required. Arm fracture confirmed by X-ray at Children's Medical Center; surgical reduction not required. **I-35E CLOSURE:** TxDOT closed I-35E SB lanes at Exit 431 from 06:02 to 09:14 hrs. Diversion to US-75 southbound. TxDOT TIM log attached as Exhibit C.

SECTION 10 — CITATIONS / CHARGES SUMMARY

Party	Statute	Violation	Fine / Disposition
Driver V2 (Thompson)	TX TC §545.062	Following Too Close — hail/reduced visibility	Civil Penalty
Driver V3 (Patel)	TX TC §545.062	Following Too Close — hail/reduced visibility	Civil Penalty
Driver V4 (Ellis)	TX TC §545.062	Following Too Close — hail/reduced visibility	Civil Penalty

SECTION 8 — OFFICER SIGN-OFF

signed

Officer Layla T. Robinson, Badge #9912
Investigating Officer, Dallas Police Department Traffic Services

March 22, 2026
Date